

B1

GRAMMAR LESSON · TIME EXPRESSIONS

During vs For vs While

during + noun (when?), for + period (how long?), while + clause (at the same time).

During / For / While Farkı

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

During, for ve **while** genellikle Türkçeye "sırasında / boyunca" diye çevrilir, ama üçü de farklı bir soruya cevap verir. **During** "ne zaman?" sorusuna, bir olayın hangi dönem içinde gerçekleştiğini söyleyerek cevap verir. **For** "ne kadar süre?" sorusuna, sürenin uzunluğunu vererek cevap verir. **While** ise iki eylemin aynı anda gerçekleştiğini bir cümleyle (özne+fiil) anlatır.

The Structure

Formula

during + isim/isim öbeği → NE ZAMAN? (the meeting, the war, the summer)

for + sayı/süre → NE KADAR? (two hours, five years, a while)

while + özne + fiil → aynı anda olan iki eylem

Kısa bir test: "during" yerine "in the course of" koyabiliyorsan during doğrudur; "for" yerine bir sayı/miktar soruluyorsa (how long?) for doğrudur.

Affirmative / Negative / Question

Kalıp	Soru	Örnek
during + isim	Ne zaman?	during the meeting
for + süre	Ne kadar süre?	for six months
while + özne+fiil	Aynı anda ne oluyordu?	while he was driving

Word Order

during/for + isim öbeği cümle sonunda veya başında olabilir; while + cümle genelde ana cümleden önce (virgülle) veya sonra gelir.

- During the exam, nobody spoke. — Sınav sırasında kimse konuşmadı.
- She waited for two hours. — İki saat bekledi.
- While I was waiting, I read a book. — Beklerken bir kitap okudum.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **during + isim (ne zaman olduğunu belirtmek) için:** I fell asleep during the film.
- **for + süre (ne kadar sürdüğünü belirtmek) için:** I lived in Paris for three years.
- **while + özne+fiil (eş zamanlı iki eylem) için:** While she was studying, he cooked dinner.
- **while, bir zıtlık anlatmak için de kullanılabilir ("ama, oysa"):** I like tea, while my sister prefers coffee.

When DON'T we use it?

During'i bir süre uzunluğuyla (sayıyla) KULLANMA — during "ne zaman", for "ne kadar" sorusuna cevap verir, birbirinin yerine geçmez.

✗ I stayed there during three weeks. → ✓ I stayed there for three weeks.

During'i tam bir cümle (özne+fiil) önünde KULLANMA: ✗ During I was sleeping, someone called. → ✓ While I was sleeping, someone called.

Short Answers

Hızlı kural: Sonrasında SAYI varsa → for. Sonrasında sadece bir İSİM (olay adı) varsa → during. Sonrasında ÖZNE+FİİL (tam cümle) varsa → while.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Tatil sırasında İtalya'ya gittik." (ne zaman? → tatilde) → SONRASINDA İSİM Mİ VAR, CÜMLE Mİ? → İsim (the holiday) → İSİM VARSA VE "NE ZAMAN" SORUSUNA CEVAP VERİYORSA → during → CÜMLE → "We went to Italy during the holiday."

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "İki hafta boyunca tatildegdik." (ne kadar süre? → iki hafta) → SÜRENİN UZUNLUĞU MU VERİLİYOR? → Evet, iki hafta → SÜRE UZUNLUĞU İSE → for → CÜMLE → "We were on holiday for two weeks."

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Ben yemek pişirirken o telefonla konuştum." (iki eylem aynı anda) → SONRASINDA ÖZNE+FİİL İÇEREN BİR CÜMLE Mİ VAR? → Evet (I was cooking) → CÜMLE VARSA → while → CÜMLE → "While I was cooking, she talked on the phone."

Examples

TEMEL

- I met my best friend during university. — En yakın arkadaşım ile üniversite sırasında tanıştım.
- They stayed at the hotel for five nights. — Otelde beş gece kaldılar.
- While you were sleeping, it started to rain. — Sen uyurken yağmur başladı.
- She fell asleep during the lecture. — Ders sırasında uykuya daldı.

ORTA SEVİYE

- We didn't speak for a whole week after the argument. — Kavgadan sonra tam bir hafta konuşmadık.
- During the power cut, we used candles. — Elektrik kesintisi sırasında mum kullandık.
- While he was reading the newspaper, his coffee got cold. — O gazete okurken kahvesi soğudu.
- I've been learning English for two years. — İki yıldır İngilizce öğreniyorum.
- Please keep your phone off during the flight. — Uçuş sırasında telefonunuzu kapalı tutun lütfen.

KARŞILAŞTIRMA

- I got a text message during the interview. — Mülakat sırasında bir mesaj aldım.
- The interview lasted for forty minutes. — Mülakat kırk dakika sürdü.
- While the interview was going on, my phone kept vibrating. — Mülakat devam ederken telefonum sürekli titriyordu.
- I prefer working in the morning, while my brother prefers the evening. — Ben sabah çalışmayı tercih ederim, kardeşim ise akşamı.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

During / For / While (bu konu)	By vs Until
Ne zaman olduğunu (during), ne kadar sürdüğünü (for) ve eş zamanlı eylemleri (while) ayırır. During the trip, we drove for six hours while it was raining.	Bir eylemin ne zamana kadar SÜRDÜĞÜNÜ (until) ya da hangi SON TARİHE kadar tamamlanacağını (by) anlatır. I'll finish it by Friday. / I'll be here until Friday.

→ By vs Until konusuna git

Karar Şeması (Decision Guide)

Soru: Sonrasında ne var — isim, sayı/süre, yoksa özne+fiil?

BİR İSİM (NE ZAMAN?)	BİR SAYI/SÜRE (NE KADAR?)	ÖZNE+FIİL (AYNI ANDA NE OLDU?)
during kullan → "during the concert"	for kullan → "for two hours"	while kullan → "while the concert was happening"

Common Mistakes

✗ I waited during two hours.	✓ I waited for two hours.
WHY? Türkçede "iki saat boyunca" ifadesindeki "boyunca" during'e benzese de, bir sayı/süre uzunluğu söz konusu olduğunda for kullanılır.	
✗ During I was cooking, the phone rang.	✓ While I was cooking, the phone rang.
WHY? during'den sonra sadece isim gelir, tam bir cümle (özne+fiil) gelmez; özne+fiil olan yerlerde while kullanılır.	
✗ I lived there during five years.	✓ I lived there for five years.
WHY? "five years" bir süre uzunluğudur (ne kadar?), during ise "ne zaman?" sorusuna cevap veren bir olay/dönem ister.	
✗ While the summer, we go to the beach every day.	✓ During the summer, we go to the beach every day.
WHY? while sadece özne+fiil içeren tam bir cümleyle kullanılır; sadece bir isim (the summer) varsa during doğru seçimdir.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 19

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. I waited _____ two hours.

- a) for b) since c) during d) while

2. Find the mistake and correct it.

During ^A I was cooking, ^B the phone rang. ^C

Correction: _____

3. I fell asleep _____ the film.

- a) while b) during c) since d) for

PART B · PRACTICE

4. I lived in Paris _____ three years.

- a) while b) in c) for d) during

5. _____ the summer, we go to the beach every day.

- a) For b) Since c) During d) While

6. _____ she was studying, he cooked dinner. (While / During)

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

I lived there ^A during ^B five years. ^C

Correction: _____

8. Your teacher asks when you felt ill. It was in the middle of the exam.

What do you say?

- a) I felt ill while the exam.
b) I felt ill during the exam.
c) I felt ill since the exam.
d) I felt ill for the exam.

9. "I like tea, while my sister prefers coffee." What does "while" mean here?

- a) during
b) but / whereas (contrast)
c) at the same time
d) for a long time

10. Please don't talk _____ the lesson.

- a) for b) while c) during d) since

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. The phone rang _____ I was in the shower.

- a) since b) for c) during d) while

12. We stayed at the hotel _____ a week.

- a) for b) during c) while d) since

13. Nobody spoke _____ the meeting. (during / while)

14. Find the mistake and correct it.

While ^A the summer, we ^B swim every day. ^C

Correction: _____

15. She's been learning Korean _____ six months.

- a) for b) since six c) during d) while

16. You tell a friend when you broke your phone. You were running.

Which sentence is correct?

- a) I dropped my phone during I was running.
b) I dropped my phone for I was running.
c) I dropped my phone while running I was.
d) I dropped my phone while I was running.

17. "During the night, it snowed." What does "during the night" tell us?

- a) when it snowed
b) how long it snowed exactly
c) why it snowed
d) where it snowed

18. Keep your phone off _____ you are driving.

- a) for b) while c) during d) since

19. Which sentence is correct?

- a) We didn't see each other for ten years.
b) We didn't see each other during ten years.
c) We didn't see each other while ten years.
d) We didn't see each other since ten years.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. **a) for** — Süre → for.
2. **A — During → While** — Özne + fiil → while.
3. **b) during** — İsim, ne zaman → during.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. **c) for** — Süre → for.
5. **c) During** — İsim → during.
6. **While** — Özne + fiil → while.
7. **B — during → for** — Süre → for.
8. **b) I felt ill during the exam.** — İsim → during.
9. **b) but / whereas (contrast)** — while → zıtlık.
10. **c) during** — İsim → during.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

11. **d) while** — Özne + fiil → while.
12. **a) for** — Süre → for.
13. **during** — İsim → during.
14. **A — While → During** — İsim → during.
15. **a) for** — Süre → for.
16. **d) I dropped my phone while I was running.** — Özne + fiil → while.
17. **a) when it snowed** — during → ne zaman.
18. **b) while** — Özne + fiil → while.
19. **a) We didn't see each other for ten years.** — Süre → for.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırımlar):
<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b1/during-vs-for-vs-while>